ENGLISH 5 · GRAMMAR AND WRITING

The Complete English Grammar Workbook

Learn the rules. Practise them. Find your own mistakes.

WHAT IS IN THIS BOOKLET

- **29 chapters** that cover the grammar you need for upper secondary English: verbs, nouns, articles, pronouns, adjectives, prepositions, linking words, punctuation and spelling.
- **Common mistakes** in every chapter, especially mistakes made by Swedish and Arabic speakers.
- **Over 200 exercises** with a full answer key, and **three texts with hidden mistakes**.
- A **proofreading method** so that you notice errors in your own writing.

Written in simple English. The rules and examples follow standard British and international English grammar. The books and websites in the Sources chapter at the end (Swan, Murphy, Cambridge, British Council and others) can be used to check any rule.

★ How to use this booklet

THE 4-ROUND METHOD

1. **Round 1: Read.** Read one chapter slowly. Say the example sentences aloud.
2. **Round 2: Cover and say.** Cover the rule boxes with a sheet of paper. Try to explain the rule in your own words. Check.
3. **Round 3: Exercises.** Do the exercises for that chapter (Part 6). Check with the answer key. Write every mistake in a list: *rule + correct sentence*.
4. **Round 4: Repeat after 2 days and after 7 days.** Do only the exercises you got wrong. This is how the rules move to your long-term memory.

A PLAN THAT WORKS

20–30 minutes a day is better than 3 hours once a week. Study **one or two chapters per day**. Then read the **Proofreading chapter (29)** and use it on every text you write. When you can find mistakes in the three hidden-mistake texts at the end, you are ready.

Symbols in this booklet

✓	correct sentence	✗	incorrect sentence (do not write this)
S, V, O	Subject, Verb, Object	**base form**	the verb without to or endings: *go, play, be*
V1, V2, V3	base form, past simple, past participle: *go – went – gone*	**sth / sb**	something / somebody

☰ Contents

Part 1 · Building blocks

1 Word classes
2 Sentences and word order
3 To be, to have, to do

Part 2 · Verbs

4 Tenses: the big picture
5 Present simple and continuous
6 Past simple and continuous
7 Present perfect
8 Past perfect
9 The future
10 Irregular verbs
11 Modal verbs
12 The passive
13 Conditionals and wishes
14 Reported speech
15 Infinitive and -ing

Part 3 · Nouns and friends

16 Nouns and quantity
17 Articles
18 Pronouns and possessives
19 Adjectives and adverbs
20 Prepositions

Part 4 · Connecting ideas

21 Linking words
22 Relative clauses
23 Question tags and short answers

Part 5 · Writing

24 Punctuation
25 Spelling rules
26 Confusing words, false friends
27 Typical mistakes
28 Writing a good text
29 Proofreading

Part 6 · Practice

Exercises 1–29
Find the mistakes (3 texts)
Answer key
Quick reference
Sources

Part 1

The building blocks

1 Word classes

Every English word belongs to a **word class** (also called a part of speech). The same word can belong to different classes: *a **walk*** (noun) and *to **walk*** (verb).

Class	Job	Examples
Noun	names a person, place, thing or idea	teacher, Stockholm, table, happiness
Pronoun	replaces a noun	he, them, mine, who, itself
Verb	action, event or state	run, become, think, be
Adjective	describes a noun	a *big* house, an *interesting* book
Adverb	describes a verb, adjective or another adverb	speak *slowly*, *very* good, *quite* well
Preposition	shows place, time or relation	in, on, at, with, for, between
Conjunction	joins words, phrases or clauses	and, but, because, although
Determiner	goes before a noun and shows which or how many	a, the, this, my, some, many
Interjection	shows a feeling	Oh! Wow! Ouch!

Parts of a sentence

KEY TERMS

- **Subject (S)**: who or what does the action. **Verb (V)**: the action or state. **Object (O)**: who or what receives the action. **Complement (C)**: information about the subject after *be, become, seem*.
- **Phrase**: a group of words without a subject + verb (*in the morning*). **Clause**: a group with subject + verb. **Sentence**: one or more clauses.
- **Main clause** can stand alone. **Subordinate clause** cannot (*because it was raining*).

> The students **(S)** wrote **(V)** an essay **(O)**. The essay **(S)** was **(V)** long **(C)**.

COMMON MISTAKE: INCOMPLETE SENTENCES

> ✗ **Because I was tired.** (This is only a subordinate clause.)
> ✓ **I went home because I was tired.**

2 Sentences and word order

2.1 Basic order: S + V + O

English word order is fixed. The verb comes **second** in a normal sentence, but it does **not** move behind the subject when something else begins the sentence (unlike Swedish).

Swedish pattern (do not copy)	English
✗ **Yesterday went I to school.**	✓ **Yesterday I went to school.**

✗ **Then came she home.**	✓ **Then she came home.**
✗ **Always I eat breakfast.**	✓ **I always eat breakfast.**

2.2 Order of adverbials: manner – place – time

> ✓ **She spoke clearly at the meeting yesterday.** (manner, place, time)

2.3 Frequency adverbs

always, usually, often, sometimes, rarely, never go **before the main verb** but **after be** and after the first auxiliary.

> ✓ **He often works late.** ✓ **He is often late.** ✓ **He has never been to Paris.**

2.4 Negative sentences

Use **do / does / did + not + base form**. With *be* and modals, add *not* directly.

Verb	Negative
I like tea.	I **do not (don't)** like tea. She **does not (doesn't)** like tea.
He went home.	He **did not (didn't)** go home. (base form after didn't!)
She is happy. / They can swim.	She **is not** happy. / They **cannot (can't)** swim.
I have finished.	I **have not (haven't)** finished.

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ **He don't like it.** → ✓ **He doesn't like it.**
> ✗ **She didn't went.** → ✓ **She didn't go.**
> ✗ **I don't know nothing.** → ✓ **I don't know anything.** (one negative only)

2.5 Questions

Type	Pattern	Example
Yes/no (be, modal, have as auxiliary)	Aux + S + V?	Is she a teacher? Can you swim? Have they left?
Yes/no (other verbs)	Do/Does/Did + S + base form?	Do you like tea? Did he call you?
Question word	Wh- + auxiliary + S + V?	Where do you live? Why did she leave?
Subject question	Wh- + V (no do!)	Who called you? What happened?

EMBEDDED QUESTIONS USE STATEMENT ORDER

> ✓ **Can you tell me where he lives?** ✗ **Can you tell me where does he live?**

2.6 Imperatives

Use the base form: *Open the door. Don't be late. Let's go.* For polite requests add *please* or use *Could you …?*

2.7 There is / There are, and it

English needs a subject in every sentence. When there is no real subject, use **there** or **it**.

> ✓ **There is a book on the table. There are two books.** (verb agrees with what follows)
>
> ✓ **It is raining. It is important to sleep. It is 5 o'clock.**

> ✗ **Is important to sleep.** ✗ **Rains today.** ✗ **In my town have a park.** → ✓ **There is a park in my town.**

3 To be, to have, to do

These three verbs are the most important in English. They work as **main verbs** and as **auxiliary verbs** (helping verbs).

Verb	Present	Past	Past participle	-ing
be	I am, you are, he/she/it is, we/you/they are	I/he/she/it was, you/we/they were	been	being
have	I/you/we/they have, he/she/it has	had	had	having
do	I/you/we/they do, he/she/it does	did	done	doing

3.1 Be

ENGLISH ALWAYS NEEDS A VERB

In some languages (for example Arabic) the verb *be* is not used in the present. In English it must always be written.

> ✗ **She very smart.** → ✓ **She is very smart.**
> ✗ **The weather nice today.** → ✓ **The weather is nice today.**

Be is also an auxiliary: *I am working* (continuous), *It was built in 1990* (passive). Use **be** + adjective for age, feelings and weather: *I am 17. I am cold. It is cold.* ✗ **I have 17 years. I have cold.**

3.2 Have

- Main verb: *I have a car.* British English also uses *have got*: *I've got a car.* Questions with main-verb *have*: *Do you have a car? / Have you got a car?*
- Auxiliary in perfect tenses: *She has finished. They had left.*
- Actions: *have breakfast, have a shower, have a good time, have a look*. Here you must use *do / does* in questions and negatives: *Do you have lunch at 12?*
- *have something done*: *I had my hair cut.* (someone else did it)

3.3 Do

- Auxiliary for questions and negatives: *Do you smoke? She doesn't know.*
- Emphasis: *I **do** like it!*
- Main verb: *do homework, do the dishes, do your best*.

3.4 Do or make?

do (activity, work, general)	make (create, produce, choose)
do homework, do the housework, do the shopping, do a job, do business, do an exam, do someone a favour, do research, do your best	make a mistake, make a decision, make an effort, make a plan, make money, make progress, make a noise, make a phone call, make a cake, make friends, make an appointment

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ **I did a mistake.** → ✓ **I made a mistake.** ✗ **make homework** → ✓ **do homework** ✗ **She have two brothers.** → ✓ **She has two brothers.**

Part 2

Verbs

4 Tenses: the big picture

A **tense** shows **when** something happens and how we see the action (finished, in progress, connected to now). English has 12 main tenses. Learn the **form** (how to build it), the **use** (when to use it) and the **signal words** (words that often go with it).

Tense	Form	Main use	Example · signal words
Present simple	V1 (+s)	habits, facts, timetables	She plays tennis. · always, usually, every day
Present continuous	am/is/are + V-ing	happening now; temporary; fixed plans	She is playing now. · now, at the moment, today
Present perfect	have/has + V3	past that connects to now	I have lived here for 5 years. · since, for, ever, never, already, yet, just
Present perfect continuous	have/has been + V-ing	action that continues or just stopped	I have been studying all day. · for, since, lately
Past simple	V2 (-ed / irregular)	finished action at a known time	I visited Rome in 2019. · yesterday, ago, last week, in 2010
Past continuous	was/were + V-ing	in progress at a past moment; background	I was sleeping when you called. · while, when, at 8 yesterday
Past perfect	had + V3	the earlier of two past events	The film had started when I arrived. · before, after, by the time
Past perfect continuous	had been + V-ing	long action before a past moment	She had been waiting for an hour. · for, since
Future (will)	will + V1	decisions now, predictions, promises	I will help you. · probably, I think, tomorrow
Future (going to)	am/is/are going to + V1	plans; predictions from evidence	I'm going to study tonight. Look at the clouds!
Future continuous	will be + V-ing	in progress at a future time	This time tomorrow I will be flying.
Future perfect	will have + V3	completed before a future time	By 2030 I will have graduated. · by

TIME PICTURE

```
PAST ──────────────── NOW ──────────────── FUTURE
 past simple | past continuous | present simple | present continuous | will / going to
 past perfect ◄── present perfect ──► (connects past with now)
```

5 Present simple and present continuous

5.1 Present simple

Form: base form. With **he / she / it** add **-s**: *I work, she works.* Questions and negatives with **do / does**: *Does she work? She doesn't work.*

Rule for he/she/it	Examples
most verbs: add **-s**	work → works, play → plays
ends in -s, -x, -z, -ch, -sh, -o: add **-es**	watch → watches, go → goes, fix → fixes, do → does
consonant + y: change to **-ies**	study → studies, carry → carries (but *play → plays*)
irregular	have → has

Use: habits and routines (*I get up at 7.*), permanent facts (*Water boils at 100°C.*), timetables (*The train leaves at 9.*), and feelings/states (*I love music.*).

5.2 Present continuous

Form: am / is / are + base form + **-ing**. **Use:** actions happening now (*I am reading.*), temporary situations (*She is staying with friends this week.*), changing situations (*The climate is getting warmer.*) and fixed plans (*We are meeting at 6.*). With **always** it can show irritation: *He is always losing his keys.*

ADDING -ING: SPELLING

make → making (drop silent e) · **run → running**, **sit → sitting** (double the last consonant after one short vowel) · **lie → lying** · **play → playing** · **travel → travelling** (UK).

5.3 State verbs (stative verbs)

Some verbs describe a **state**, not an action. They are normally **not** used in the continuous: *know, understand, believe, remember, forget, like, love, hate, want, need, prefer, belong, own, seem, mean, contain, cost, depend.*

> ✗ **I am knowing the answer.** → ✓ **I know the answer.** ✗ **She is wanting a coffee.** → ✓ **She wants a coffee.**

Some verbs have two meanings: *I **think** it's good* (opinion) / *I **am thinking** about my holiday* (action). ***She has a car / She is having lunch. I see what you mean / I am seeing the doctor tomorrow.***

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ **He go to school every day.** → ✓ **He goes to school every day.** **(third person -s)**
> ✗ **She is work in a bank.** → ✓ **She works in a bank. / She is working in a bank.**
> ✗ **I am go to school now.** → ✓ **I am going to school now.** **(be + -ing)**
> ✗ **Do he like pizza?** → ✓ **Does he like pizza?** **(does + base form; no -s on the verb)**

6 Past simple and past continuous

6.1 Past simple

Form: regular verbs + -ed (*walked, studied, stopped*); irregular verbs have special forms (*go → went*, see chapter 10). Questions and negatives: did + base form.

> ✓ **Did you see the film?** ✗ **Did you saw the film?** ✓ **I didn't go.** ✗ **I didn't went.**

Use: finished actions at a known time (*I met her in 2020 / yesterday / two years ago*), a series of events in a story (*He opened the door, walked in and sat down.*) and past habits (*We played football every day.*).

SPELLING OF -ED

stop → stopped (double consonant) · study → studied (y → ied) · like → liked (add d) · play → played (vowel + y: no change). Pronunciation: /t/ after voiceless sounds (*worked*), /d/ after voiced (*played*), /ɪd/ after t and d (*wanted, needed*).

6.2 Past continuous

Form: was / were + -ing. Use: an action in progress at a past moment (*At 8 last night I was cooking.*), the background to a story (*It was raining and people were hurrying.*) and an action that was interrupted (*I was cooking when she called.*).

Combination	Example
when + past simple (short action interrupts)	I was walking home when it started to rain.
while + past continuous (two long actions)	While I was studying, my brother was playing music.

6.3 Used to and would

used to + base form: past habits and states that are no longer true: *I used to live in Malmö. She used to be shy.* Negative/question: *I didn't use to smoke. Did you use to play?* would + base form is only for repeated actions, not states: *Every summer we would swim in the lake.* ✗ I would live in Malmö. (state: use *used to*)

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ I was born in 2008. I live here since then. → see chapter 7.
> ✗ Yesterday I have seen her. → ✓ Yesterday I saw her. (finished time = past simple)
> ✗ She was go to the shop. → ✓ She went / was going to the shop.

7 Present perfect

7.1 Present perfect simple

Form: have / has + past participle (V3). Regular V3 = V2 (*worked*). Irregular: see chapter 10.

Use: a past action or state that is connected to the present. The time is not finished or not important.

Use	Example
a state or action that began in the past and continues now	I have lived here for ten years. She has worked here since 2019.
experience in your life (ever / never)	Have you ever been to London? I have never eaten sushi.
recent action with a result now (just / already / yet)	I have just finished. She has already left. Have you done it yet?
unfinished time period (today, this week, this year)	I have seen three films this week.

FOR, SINCE, AGO

for + length of time: *for two hours, for a week, for years* · since + starting point: *since 2020, since Monday, since I was a child* · ago + past simple: *I started two years ago.*

7.2 Present perfect vs past simple

Present perfect	Past simple

no finished time mentioned, or time not finished	finished time mentioned or understood
I have visited Paris. (in my life) I have had three coffees today.	I visited Paris in 2019. I had three coffees yesterday.

RULE OF THUMB

You can never use the present perfect with a word for a finished time: *yesterday, last week, in 2010, two years ago, when I was a child, at 5 o'clock.*

7.3 Present perfect continuous

Form: have / has been + -ing. It stresses the activity and its duration: *I have been waiting for an hour.* or a recent activity with a visible result: *Your eyes are red. Have you been crying?* Compare: *I have written 3 emails* (result, number) / *I have been writing emails all morning* (activity). State verbs (*know, like*) use the simple form: ✓ I have known her for years.

7.4 Been or gone?

> *She has been to Spain.* (she visited and came back) *She has gone to Spain.* (she is there now)

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ I have seen him yesterday. → ✓ I saw him yesterday.
> ✗ I live here since 2020. / ✗ I am here since Monday. → ✓ I have lived here since 2020. / I have been here since Monday.
> ✗ I know her since 5 years. → ✓ I have known her for 5 years. (*for*, not *since*, with a length of time)
> ✗ When have you arrived? → ✓ When did you arrive? (question with *when* = past simple)

8 Past perfect

FORM AND USE

Form: had + past participle (V3). Same for all persons: *I had finished, she had finished.* Negative: *hadn't finished*. Question: *Had you finished?*

Use: the earlier of two past events. The later event is in past simple.

> *When I arrived, the film had already started.* (first: film starts, second: I arrive)

> *She was tired because she had worked all night.*

> *I had never seen snow before I moved to Sweden.*

Past simple + past simple (order of events)	Past perfect + past simple (earlier first)
I got home. I ate dinner. (first home, then dinner)	When I got home, my mum had already eaten. (she ate before I came)
When he called, I left. (he called, then I left)	When he called, I had already left. (I left first)

Typical signal words

before, after, by the time, when, already, just, never … before, as soon as, until. After *after* you can use past perfect or past simple: *After I had eaten / After I ate, I went out.*

Past perfect continuous

had been + V-ing: a longer action that went on up to a past moment. *She was red in the face. She had been running. We had been waiting for an hour when the bus came.*

Reported speech and conditionals

Past perfect is also the "back-shift" tense in reported speech (ch. 14) and is used in the third conditional (ch. 13): *If I had studied, I would have passed.*

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ When I came, he already left. → ✓ When I came, he had already left.

> ✗ If I would have known, I would have helped. → ✓ If I had known, I would have helped.

> ✗ I had went there. → ✓ I had gone there. (always V3 after *had*)

> ✗ He said he has finished. → ✓ He said he had finished.

9 Talking about the future

English has no single future tense. You choose a form depending on why you speak about the future.

Form	Use	Example
will + V1	decision made now; prediction (opinion); promise, offer, threat; facts about the future	"The phone is ringing." "I'll get it." · I think it will rain. · I'll help you. · I will be 18 next year.
be going to + V1	plan made before speaking; prediction from evidence you can see	I'm going to study medicine. · Look at those clouds. It's going to rain.
present continuous	fixed arrangement with time and place (often with a person involved)	I'm meeting Sara at 6 tomorrow. · We're flying to Rome on Friday.
present simple	timetables, schedules, calendars	The train leaves at 7.45. · School starts on Monday.
will be + V-ing	in progress at a future moment; polite questions about plans	This time tomorrow I'll be flying. · Will you be using the car tonight?
will have + V3	finished before a future moment	By June I will have finished school.
be about to + V1	very soon, in a moment	Hurry up! The film is about to start.

Will or going to?

USE WILL FOR

- spontaneous decisions: *I'll have the pasta.*
- opinions / guesses: *I think he'll win.* (I believe, probably, perhaps)
- promises: *I won't tell anyone.*

USE GOING TO FOR

- plans: *I'm going to learn Spanish.*
- predictions with evidence: *He's going to fall!*
- things you have already decided: *We're going to move.*

Time clauses: the big rule

RULE

After when, while, before, after, as soon as, until, by the time, if, unless, once we use a present tense for the future, never *will*.

> ✓ When I arrive, I will call you. ✓ If it rains, we will stay home. ✓ I'll wait until you finish.

> ✓ I will have left before you arrive. ✓ As soon as she has finished, we'll go. (present perfect also works)

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ When I will arrive, I will call you. → ✓ When I arrive, I will call you.

> ✗ If it will rain tomorrow, … → ✓ If it rains tomorrow, …

> ✗ I will to go. → ✓ I will go. (no *to* after *will*)

> ✗ Tomorrow I go to the cinema. (if it is only a plan) → ✓ Tomorrow I'm going to the cinema.

> ✗ I am knowing the answer tomorrow. → ✓ I will know the answer tomorrow.

10 Irregular verbs

Regular verbs add -ed in V2 and V3 (*work, worked, worked*). Irregular verbs change in other ways. Many are very common, so you must know them by heart. Cover two columns and test yourself.

V1	V2	V3
be	was / were	been
become	became	become
begin	began	begun
bite	bit	bitten
blow	blew	blown
break	broke	broken
bring	brought	brought
build	built	built
buy	bought	bought
catch	caught	caught
choose	chose	chosen
come	came	come
cost	cost	cost
cut	cut	cut
deal	dealt	dealt
do	did	done
draw	drew	drawn
drink	drank	drunk
drive	drove	driven
eat	ate	eaten
fall	fell	fallen
feed	fed	fed
feel	felt	felt
fight	fought	fought
find	found	found
fly	flew	flown
forget	forgot	forgotten
forgive	forgave	forgiven
freeze	froze	frozen

V1	V2	V3
get	got	got
give	gave	given
go	went	gone / been
grow	grew	grown
hang	hung	hung
have	had	had
hear	heard	heard
hide	hid	hidden
hit	hit	hit
hold	held	held
hurt	hurt	hurt
keep	kept	kept
know	knew	known
lay	laid	laid
lead	led	led
leave	left	left
lend	lent	lent
let	let	let
lie	lay	lain
lose	lost	lost
make	made	made
mean	meant	meant
meet	met	met
pay	paid	paid
put	put	put
quit	quit	quit
read	read /rɛd/	read /rɛd/
ride	rode	ridden
ring	rang	rung
rise	rose	risen

V1	V2	V3
run	ran	run
say	said	said
see	saw	seen
sell	sold	sold
send	sent	sent
set	set	set
shake	shook	shaken
shine	shone	shone
shoot	shot	shot
show	showed	shown
shut	shut	shut
sing	sang	sung
sink	sank	sunk
sit	sat	sat
sleep	slept	slept
speak	spoke	spoken
spend	spent	spent
stand	stood	stood
steal	stole	stolen
swim	swam	swum
take	took	taken
teach	taught	taught
tear	tore	torn
tell	told	told
think	thought	thought
throw	threw	thrown
understand	understood	understood
wake	woke	woken
wear	wore	worn
win	won	won
write	wrote	written

Patterns that help you remember

- **Same in all three: cost, cut, hit, hurt, let, put, quit, set, shut.**
- **V2 = V3 (-ought / -aught): bring/brought, buy/bought, catch/caught, teach/taught, think/thought, fight/fought.**
- **i – a – u: begin/began/begun, drink/drank/drunk, ring/rang/rung, sing/sang/sung, swim/swam/swum, sink/sank/sunk.**
- **V3 ends in -n: break/broken, choose/chosen, speak/spoken, steal/stolen, wake/woken, write/written, eat/eaten, fall/fallen.**

Confusing pairs

Verb	Meaning	Forms	Example
lie (lie, lay, lain)	rest flat; no object	lying	I lay on the sofa yesterday.
lay (lay, laid, laid)	put something down; needs an object	laying	She laid the book on the table.
lie (lied, lied)	say something untrue	lying	He lied about his age.
rise (rose, risen)	go up by itself; no object	rising	The sun rises. Prices have risen.
raise (raised, raised)	lift / increase something; needs an object	raising	They raised the price.
hang (hung, hung)	things; hang (hanged, hanged) = execute a person		She hung her coat up.
learn / teach	learn = get knowledge; teach = give knowledge		She teaches me. I learn English.
borrow / lend	borrow = take for a time; lend = give for a time		Can I borrow your pen? Can you lend me your pen?

11 Modal verbs

Modal verbs: can, could, may, might, will, would, shall, should, must, ought to. They are followed by the base form (no *to*, no *-s*, no *-ing*) and make questions and negatives without do.

> ✓ She can swim. ✗ She cans swim. ✓ Can he swim? ✗ Does he can swim? ✓ I must go. ✗ I must to go.

Meaning	Modal	Example
ability	can / could / be able to	I can run 5 km. · She could read at four. · He was able to escape (one time).
permission	can, could, may (formal)	Can I go? · May I come in?
request	could, would, can, will (can/will are less polite)	Could you open the window? · Would you mind helping me?
offer / suggestion	shall, can, could, should	Shall I carry that? · We could go to the park.
advice	should, ought to, had better	You should sleep more. · You'd better hurry.
obligation	must, have to, need to	You must wear a seatbelt. · I have to work tomorrow.
prohibition	mustn't, can't, not allowed to	You mustn't smoke here.
no obligation	don't have to, needn't, don't need to	You don't have to come.
certainty / probability	must (sure), will, should, may/might/could (possible), can't (sure not)	He must be at home. · It may rain. · That can't be true.

MUSTN'T ≠ DON'T HAVE TO

You mustn't go = it is forbidden. You don't have to go = it is not necessary (you can go if you want).

Past: modal + have + V3

Form	Meaning	Example
must have + V3	I am sure it happened	He isn't here. He must have left.
can't / couldn't have + V3	I am sure it did not happen	She can't have seen me. I was not there.
may / might / could have + V3	maybe it happened	He might have missed the bus.
should have + V3	it was a good idea, but you did not do it (criticism / regret)	I should have studied more.
shouldn't have + V3	you did it, but it was a bad idea	You shouldn't have said that.
needn't have + V3	you did it, but it was not necessary	I needn't have brought an umbrella.
would have + V3	result of an imaginary past (3rd conditional)	I would have helped if I had known.

Past of must (obligation): *had to*. Future of must: *will have to*. Could / was able to: *could* = general ability in the past; *was able to* = managed to do something one time. *The fire spread, but everyone was able to escape.*

COMMON MISTAKES

- ✗ He can speaks English. → ✓ He can speak English.
- ✗ You must not to be late. → ✓ You must not be late.
- ✗ I didn't could come. → ✓ I couldn't come.
- ✗ I should have went. → ✓ I should have gone.
- ✗ You mustn't come if you don't want to. → ✓ You don't have to come if you don't want to.
- ✗ I would can help you. → ✓ I would be able to help you. (two modals never go together)

12 The passive

FORM

be (in the right tense) + past participle (V3). The object of the active sentence becomes the subject.

> ***Active:*** **Shakespeare wrote Hamlet.** → ***Passive:*** **Hamlet was written by Shakespeare.**

Tense	Passive form	Example
present simple	am/is/are + V3	English is spoken all over the world.
past simple	was/were + V3	The window was broken yesterday.
present perfect	has/have been + V3	The homework has been done.
past perfect	had been + V3	The room had been cleaned.
present continuous	am/is/are being + V3	The road is being repaired.
past continuous	was/were being + V3	I was being watched.
will	will be + V3	The results will be announced on Friday.

modal	modal + be + V3	This must be finished today. It can't be changed.
infinitive	to be + V3	She wants to be invited.
-ing form	being + V3	I hate being told what to do.

When do we use the passive?

- The doer is unknown or unimportant: *My bike was stolen.*
- The action or result is more important than the doer: *The bridge was built in 1998.*
- Formal / scientific writing: *The samples were heated to 80 °C.*
- Use by + agent only when the doer is important or new information: *Hamlet was written by Shakespeare.*

Two objects

Verbs with two objects (give, send, show, tell, offer) have two passives: *She gave me a book. → I was given a book. / A book was given to me.*

Passive with reporting verbs

It is said that he is rich. = He is said to be rich. Also: believed, thought, known, expected, reported, claimed.

Have something done

When someone else does a service for you: have + object + V3. *I had my hair cut. She is having her car repaired.* (not *I cut my hair*, unless you did it yourself.)

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ The accident was happened yesterday. → ✓ The accident happened yesterday. (*happen, occur, arrive, die, fall, seem, exist* have no passive)

> ✗ The book writes by him. → ✓ The book was written by him.

> ✗ It was cost 10 euros. → ✓ It cost 10 euros.

> ✗ The letter was sended. → ✓ The letter was sent. (V3 of irregular verbs)

> ✗ I am agree. → ✓ I agree.

13 Conditionals and wishes

A conditional sentence has an if-clause (condition) and a main clause (result). If the if-clause comes first, put a comma. *If it rains, we stay home. / We stay home if it rains.*

Type	If-clause	Main clause	Meaning · example
Zero	present simple	present simple	always true, facts: *If you heat ice, it melts.*
First	present simple	will + V1	real, possible future: *If I study, I will pass.*
Second	past simple	would + V1	unreal / unlikely now or future: *If I had a million, I would travel.*
Third	past perfect	would have + V3	unreal past, too late: *If I had studied, I would have passed.*
Mixed	past perfect	would + V1	past cause, present result: *If I had slept, I would be fine now.*

DETAILS THAT MATTER

- In the second conditional use were for all persons in formal English: *If I were you, I would apologise.*
- Never put *will* or *would* in the if-clause: *If I had time* (not *if I would have time*).
- unless = if … not: *Unless you hurry, you'll be late.* (= If you don't hurry)
- Other modals are possible in the main clause: *If you work hard, you can / may / should succeed.*
- Inversion (formal): *Had I known, I would have come.* · *Should you need help, call me.* · *Were I rich, I would retire.*
- as long as, provided (that), on condition that mean "only if": *You can go provided you finish your work.*

Wishes

Situation	Pattern	Example
wish about now (unreal)	wish + past simple	I wish I had a car. · I wish I were taller.
regret about the past	wish + past perfect	I wish I had studied more.
annoyance, wanting change	wish + would	I wish you would stop talking.
If only	stronger than wish; same patterns	If only I knew! · If only I had listened!
would rather	would rather + V1 · would rather + person + past simple	I'd rather stay. · I'd rather you stayed.

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ If I will see him, I will tell him. → ✓ If I see him, I will tell him.

> ✗ If I would have money, I would buy it. → ✓ If I had money, I would buy it.

> ✗ If I had known, I would helped. → ✓ If I had known, I would have helped.

> ✗ I wish I can fly. → ✓ I wish I could fly.

14 Reported speech

We report what someone said without quoting the exact words. If the reporting verb is in the past (*said, told, asked*), the tense usually moves one step back.

Direct speech	Reported speech
present simple: "I like pizza."	She said (that) she liked pizza.
present continuous: "I'm working."	He said he was working.
past simple: "I saw him."	She said she had seen him.
present perfect: "I've finished."	He said he had finished.
will: "I will call."	She said she would call.
can: "I can swim."	He said he could swim.
may: "I may go."	She said she might go.
must: "I must go."	He said he had to go.

No back-shift is needed when the reporting verb is present (*She says she likes pizza*) or when the statement is still true (*He said the Earth is round*). *should, would, could, might* do not change.

Other changes

Direct	Reported	Direct	Reported
now	then / at that time	here	there
today	that day	this	that
tomorrow	the next day / the following day	yesterday	the day before
ago	before	next week	the following week

Pronouns change too: ***"I love my job," he said. → He said he loved his job.***

Questions, commands, requests

- **Yes/no questions: if / whether + statement order.** ***"Do you like tea?" → She asked if I liked tea.***
- **Wh-questions: wh-word + statement order (no do/does/did).** ***"Where do you live?" → He asked where I lived.***
- **Commands: told + person + to-infinitive.** ***"Sit down!" → She told me to sit down.*** **Negative:** ***told me not to.***
- **Requests: asked + person + to-infinitive.** ***"Please help me." → He asked me to help him.***

Reporting verbs

Pattern	Verbs and examples
say (that)	say, explain, mention, add, claim. ***She said (that) she was tired.*** · say to someone: ***She said to me …***
tell + person	***She told me (that) she was tired.*** (tell always has a person after it)
verb + to-inf	promise, offer, refuse, agree, threaten: ***He promised to come.***
verb + person + to-inf	advise, warn, invite, remind, persuade, order: ***She warned me not to go.***
verb + -ing	suggest, admit, deny, recommend: ***He suggested going out.*** · ***She denied taking it.***
verb + preposition + -ing	apologise for, insist on, accuse sb of: ***He apologised for being late.***

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ She said me that she was ill. → ✓ She told me that she was ill. / She said that she was ill.
>
> ✗ He asked me where did I live. → ✓ He asked me where I lived.
>
> ✗ She asked if could she come. → ✓ She asked if she could come.
>
> ✗ He suggested me to go. → ✓ He suggested that I go / suggested going.

15 Infinitive and -ing form; phrasal verbs

15.1 Which verb pattern follows which verb?

After many verbs you must choose between to + base (infinitive) and -ing (gerund). You have to learn them in groups.

Pattern	Verbs
+ to-infinitive	agree, decide, expect, hope, learn, manage, offer, plan, promise, refuse, seem, want, would like, need, afford, fail, choose, arrange, pretend, appear
+ -ing	enjoy, avoid, finish, keep, mind, miss, practise, suggest, consider, imagine, risk, delay, deny, admit, give up, can't help, look forward to, be used to, be worth, it's no use

+ object + to-inf	want, ask, tell, allow, advise, expect, invite, order, teach, force, remind, encourage, persuade
+ object + base form	make, let, see/hear/watch somebody do: *She made me laugh. They let us go.*
+ either (almost same meaning)	like, love, hate, prefer, start, begin, continue: *I like swimming / to swim.*

Verbs where the meaning changes

Verb	+ to-infinitive	+ -ing
remember	remember to lock = not forget to do it	remember locking = recall that you did it
forget	forget to post = fail to do it	forget posting = lose the memory of having done it
stop	stop to rest = stop in order to	stop resting = end the action
try	try to open = make an effort	try opening = experiment
regret	regret to inform = sorry to say	regret telling = sorry I did

15.2 Purpose, adjectives, prepositions

- Purpose: to + base. *I went to the shop to buy milk.* (not *for buy*, not *for buying*) Negative: *in order not to*.
- Adjective + to-inf: *happy to help, easy to learn, ready to go.*
- After a preposition always -ing: *interested in learning, good at swimming, thank you for helping, before leaving, instead of going.*
- to + -ing after some phrases (to is a preposition): *look forward to seeing, be used to working, object to paying.*
- Subject: an -ing form can be a subject: *Swimming is fun.*

> **USED TO / BE USED TO / GET USED TO**
>
> used to + V1 = past habit (ch. 6): *I used to smoke.*
> be/get used to + -ing = be/become accustomed: *I am used to getting up early. I'm getting used to living here.*

15.3 Phrasal verbs

A phrasal verb = verb + particle (up, out, off, in, on, away, back, down). The meaning is often different from the verb itself. Learn them as whole units.

Separable (object can go in the middle): *turn off the light / turn the light off / turn it off*. With a pronoun the pronoun must go in the middle: ✓ turn it off, ✗ turn off it.

Inseparable: *look after the baby, look after her* (not *look her after*).

give up stop trying
give back return
look up search for
look after take care of
look forward to wait eagerly
find out discover
carry on continue
run out of have none left
put off postpone
put up with tolerate
take off remove; leave the ground
turn down refuse; lower
get on with have good relations
get over recover from
set up establish
work out solve; exercise
break down stop working
come up with invent an idea

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ I enjoy to swim. → ✓ I enjoy swimming.
>
> ✗ I want that you help me. → ✓ I want you to help me.
>
> ✗ She made me to cry. → ✓ She made me cry.
>
> ✗ I'm looking forward to see you. → ✓ I'm looking forward to seeing you.
>
> ✗ I use my phone for to call. → ✓ I use my phone to call.
>
> ✗ He decided going. → ✓ He decided to go.

Part 3

Nouns and friends

16 Nouns and quantity

16.1 Plurals

Rule	Examples
most nouns: add -s	book → books, day → days
ends in -s, -x, -z, -ch, -sh: add -es	bus → buses, box → boxes, watch → watches, dish → dishes
consonant + y → -ies	city → cities, baby → babies (but day → days, key → keys)
-f / -fe → -ves	knife → knives, leaf → leaves, life → lives, wife → wives (roof → roofs)
consonant + o → often -es	potato → potatoes, hero → heroes (photo → photos, piano → pianos)
irregular	man → men, woman → women, child → children, foot → feet, tooth → teeth, mouse → mice, person → people
same singular and plural	sheep, fish, deer, series, species, aircraft
Latin / Greek	analysis → analyses, crisis → crises, phenomenon → phenomena, criterion → criteria, datum → data

16.2 Countable and uncountable nouns

COUNTABLE

can be counted: *a book, two books*. Use a/an, numbers, many, few, a few, fewer.

UNCOUNTABLE

cannot be counted; no plural, no *a/an*. Use much, little, a little, less, or "a piece of / a bit of".

Common uncountable nouns: *information, advice, news, furniture, luggage, equipment, homework, money, music, traffic, weather, knowledge, progress, research, work, travel, evidence, bread, water, rice, hair, health, help, permission*. They take a singular verb: *The news is good. My hair is long.*

✗ Wrong	✓ Right
✗ informations, advices, furnitures, luggages, homeworks	✓ information, advice, furniture, luggage, homework · a piece of advice, two pieces of furniture
✗ an advice, a research, a knowledge	✓ a piece of advice, a study / some research, knowledge

16.3 Quantifiers

	Countable plural	Uncountable
a lot of / lots of / plenty of	a lot of friends	a lot of money
many / much	many students (questions, negatives)	much time (questions, negatives)
few / little (almost none, negative)	few people came	little time
a few / a little (some, positive)	a few friends	a little water
fewer / less	fewer cars	less traffic

some / any	some apples · Do you have any?	some milk · I don't have any.
enough	enough chairs	enough food

some is used in positive sentences and offers/requests (*Would you like some tea?*). any in negatives and most questions. every / each / all: *every* + singular (*every student is*); *all* + plural (*all students are*); *each* = one by one.

16.4 Possessive 's

- singular: *the girl's bag* · plural ending in -s: *the girls' bags* · irregular plural: *the children's toys*.
- Names ending in s: *James's book* or *James' book* (both correct; be consistent).
- For things use of: *the end of the film* (not *the film's end*), *the door of the car*.
- its (possessive) ≠ it's (it is / it has).

16.5 Subject-verb agreement

- Singular subject → singular verb: *The list of items is long.* (the subject is *list*)
- each, every, everyone, everybody, nobody, something, either, neither + singular verb: *Everyone is ready.*
- Two subjects with and → plural: *Tom and Ann are here.*
- either … or / neither … nor / not only … but also: the verb agrees with the nearer subject: *Neither the teacher nor the students were there.*
- Names of subjects and illnesses with -s are singular: *Mathematics is hard. Physics is fun. The news is bad.*
- Always plural: *people, police, children, clothes, trousers, glasses, scissors*: *The police are here.*
- Money, distance, time as a unit: *Ten dollars is a lot. Five years is a long time.*

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ There are many informations. → ✓ There is a lot of information.

> ✗ Less people came. → ✓ Fewer people came.

> ✗ Everyone are happy. → ✓ Everyone is happy.

> ✗ My friend's are nice. → ✓ My friends are nice. (plural has no apostrophe)

> ✗ The people is angry. → ✓ The people are angry.

17 Articles: a, an, the, no article

Article	Use	Example
a / an	one of many; first mention; jobs; with "such", "what", "quite", "half", "many"	I saw a dog. She is an engineer. What a day!
the	specific thing both know; already mentioned; only one; superlatives; ordinal numbers; rivers, seas, mountain ranges, countries with "republic/kingdom/states"	The dog was big. The sun. The best. The second time. The Nile, the Alps, the USA, the UK
no article	plural and uncountable nouns in general; most countries, cities, languages, meals, sports, subjects, "go to school/bed/work"	Dogs are loyal. Water is life. I speak English. She plays football. We had lunch.

a before a consonant sound, an before a vowel sound: *a university* (/juː/), *an hour* (silent h), *an MP*, *a one-day trip*.

Fixed expressions

Without article (institution's purpose)	With article (the building)
go to school, university, hospital (as a patient), church, prison, bed, work, town	go to the school (to meet a teacher), the hospital (to visit), the bank, the cinema, the shop

by car / bus / train / bike; at home; in class	in the car; at the station

More rules

- the + adjective = group of people: *the poor, the rich, the young, the elderly*.
- the + musical instruments: *play the guitar*; sports: no article: *play football*.
- Decades: *in the 1990s*. Dates: *on the 5th of May*.
- Names: no article (*Mr Smith, Sweden, Stockholm, Lake Mälaren, Mount Everest*), but *the Netherlands, the Philippines, the Atlantic, the Thames*.
- "In general" → no article; "specific" → the. *I love music.* but *The music at the party was loud.*
- Once, twice a day: *twice a week*, *60 km an hour*.

COMMON MISTAKES (SWEDISH AND ARABIC SPEAKERS)

> ✗ The life is hard. / The money is important. (general) → ✓ Life is hard. Money is important.

> ✗ I am student. / She is teacher. → ✓ I am a student. She is a teacher.

> ✗ I go to the school every day. → ✓ I go to school every day.

> ✗ I have a homework. → ✓ I have homework.

> ✗ I want to be doctor. → ✓ I want to be a doctor.

> ✗ in the Sweden / in the Stockholm → ✓ in Sweden / in Stockholm

18 Pronouns and possessives

Subject	Object	Possessive adjective	Possessive pronoun	Reflexive
I	me	my	mine	myself
you	you	your	yours	yourself / yourselves
he	him	his	his	himself
she	her	her	hers	herself
it	it	its	—	itself
we	us	our	ours	ourselves
they	them	their	theirs	themselves

- Subject pronoun = does the action; object pronoun = receives it or follows a preposition: *She gave it to me.* After *between, with, for, to* always object: *between you and me*.
- Possessive adjective before a noun: *my book*. Possessive pronoun stands alone: *The book is mine.*
- Reflexive: when subject and object are the same: *I cut myself.* Or for emphasis: *I did it myself.* No reflexive after *wash, shave, dress, feel, relax, concentrate* if meaning is clear: *I washed. She feels tired.*
- each other / one another: *They help each other.* (not *themselves*)
- Indefinite: someone, anyone, no one, everyone, something, anything, nothing, everything. Use *they/their* for unknown gender: *Someone left their bag.*
- Demonstratives: this/these (near), that/those (far): *this book here, those books over there*.
- Double negative is wrong in standard English: ✗ I don't know nothing. → ✓ I don't know anything / I know nothing.

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ Me and my friend went home. → ✓ My friend and I went home.

> ✗ He gave it to she. → ✓ He gave it to her.

> ✗ The book is her's. / It's own colour. → ✓ The book is hers. / Its own colour. (no apostrophe in possessives)

> ✗ They love themselves. (meaning each other) → ✓ They love each other.

> ✗ He took his bike and she took hers bike. → ✓ … and she took hers.

19 Adjectives and adverbs

19.1 Adjectives

- Adjectives have no plural form: *two tall men* (not *talls*). They stand before the noun or after *be, seem, feel, look, become*.
- Order before a noun: opinion – size – age – shape – colour – origin – material – purpose + noun. *a beautiful small old round red Italian leather bag*. In practice use two or three adjectives at most.
- -ed / -ing: *I am bored* (feeling) / *The film is boring* (cause). Also: interested/interesting, excited/exciting, tired/tiring, surprised/surprising.
- Compound adjectives with numbers use singular: *a ten-year-old girl, a two-hour film*.

19.2 Comparison

Type	Comparative	Superlative
short (1 syllable): +er / +est	tall → taller	tall → the tallest
ends in -e: +r / +st	nice → nicer	the nicest
short with one vowel + one consonant: double	big → bigger, hot → hotter	the biggest, the hottest
consonant + y → -ier / -iest	happy → happier	the happiest
long (2+ syllables): more / most	more beautiful	the most beautiful
irregular	good → better · bad → worse · far → farther/further · little → less · much/many → more	the best · the worst · the farthest/furthest · the least · the most

- Comparative + than: *taller than me*. Same level: *as tall as*. Not the same: *not as tall as*.
- Two comparatives: *The more you practise, the better you get.* · *It's getting colder and colder.*
- Superlative needs *the* and often *in/of*: *the best student in the class.*
- Strengthen: *much / far / a lot taller* (not *very taller*).

19.3 Adverbs

Adverbs describe verbs, adjectives, other adverbs or whole sentences. Many are formed with -ly: *quick → quickly, careful → carefully, happy → happily, possible → possibly, true → truly*.

Adjective	Adverb	Note
good	well	She is a good singer. She sings well.
fast, hard, late, early	same word	He works hard. (*hardly* = almost not) · She arrived late. (*lately* = recently)

friendly, lovely, lonely, elderly	(no -ly adverb)	use "in a friendly way"

After sense verbs (look, feel, sound, taste, smell, seem, become) use an adjective: *You look tired. It sounds good. The soup tastes great.*

Intensifiers: very, really, extremely, quite, rather, too (negative: more than needed), enough (after adjective: *old enough*). *too ≠ very*: *It's too cold to swim.*

COMMON MISTAKES

- ✗ more taller / most happiest → ✓ taller / happiest (never both)
- ✗ He runs very quick. → ✓ He runs very quickly.
- ✗ She speaks English good. → ✓ She speaks English well.
- ✗ I feel me bad. → ✓ I feel bad.
- ✗ He is more tall than me. → ✓ He is taller than me.
- ✗ I am very agree. / I'm very interesting in sport. → ✓ I agree. / I'm very interested in sport.

20 Prepositions

20.1 Time

Preposition	Use	Examples
at	exact time, night, weekend (UK), holidays	at 5 o'clock, at night, at the weekend, at Christmas
on	days, dates, specific days	on Monday, on 5 May, on my birthday, on Friday evening
in	months, years, seasons, centuries, parts of day	in May, in 2024, in summer, in the morning (but: at night)
for / since	duration / starting point	for two years / since 2022
during / while	during + noun; while + clause	during the lesson / while I was reading
by / until	by = no later than; until = up to that time	Finish by Friday. I'll stay until Friday.
in / within / after	in = from now; within = inside the period	I'll call you in ten minutes. Within a week.

20.2 Place and movement

Preposition	Use	Examples
in	inside; cities, countries; enclosed space	in the box, in Sweden, in a car, in bed
on	surface; streets; floors; transport you walk on	on the table, on Storgatan, on the 3rd floor, on the bus/train
at	a point; addresses; events	at the door, at school, at 5 Main Street, at a concert
to / into / onto	movement towards / inside / on top	go to school, jump into the water, climb onto the roof
under / over / above / below	vertical positions	under the table, over the bridge, above the clouds, below zero

between / among	between 2 things; among 3 or more	between you and me; among the trees
across / through / along / around	movement	across the road, through the tunnel, along the river, around the corner
next to / beside / near / opposite	closeness	The bank is opposite the school.

20.3 Fixed combinations (learn as a unit)

Adjective + prep.	Verb + prep.	Noun + prep.
afraid of	depend on	reason for
angry with (a person) / at (a thing)	listen to	cause of
good at	look at	increase in
bad at	wait for	demand for
interested in	belong to	solution to
proud of	believe in	answer to
famous for	agree with (a person) / to (a plan) / on (a topic)	invitation to
responsible for	apologise for	difference between
different from / to	arrive in (city) / at (place)	problem with
similar to	laugh at	interest in
married to	think about / of	on time / in time
worried about	spend money on	in fact
tired of	pay for	on purpose
keen on	complain about	by mistake
capable of	result in	by hand
aware of	consist of	in the end / at the end
full of	succeed in	in my opinion
dependent on	insist on	on the one hand / on the other hand
afraid of	suffer from	at first
satisfied with	talk to / about	on average

VERBS WITHOUT A PREPOSITION IN ENGLISH

discuss the problem (not discuss about) · ***marry*** her (not marry with) · ***enter*** the room (not enter to) · ***reach*** the city · ***answer*** the question · ***attend*** the meeting · ***mention*** it · ***approach*** the door · ***emphasise*** · ***resemble*** · ***lack*** · ***obey***

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ I am agree with you. / I agree on you. → ✓ I agree with you.

> ✗ We discussed about the plan. → ✓ We discussed the plan.

> ✗ I'm good in English. / I am interested on music. → ✓ I'm good at English. / I'm interested in music.

> ✗ She depends of her parents. → ✓ She depends on her parents.

> ✗ I live in Storgatan. / on the school → ✓ I live on Storgatan. / at school

> ✗ I am here since Monday. → ✓ I have been here since Monday.

> ✗ In Monday / at the morning / on 2024 → ✓ On Monday / in the morning / in 2024

Part 4

Connecting ideas

21 Linking words

Linking words (connectors) show the relation between ideas. They make your writing flow and are an important part of a high grade.

Function	Linkers	Example
adding	and, also, in addition, moreover, furthermore, besides, as well as, not only … but also	The course is cheap. Moreover, it is useful.
contrast	but, however, although, though, even though, despite, in spite of, whereas, while, on the other hand, nevertheless, yet	I was tired, but I kept going. Although it rained, we went out.
reason	because, as, since, because of, due to, owing to	We stayed in because of the rain.
result	so, therefore, as a result, consequently, thus, that is why	It rained. As a result, the match was cancelled.
purpose	to, in order to, so that, so as to	I study so that I can get into university.
condition	if, unless, as long as, provided that, otherwise	Hurry up, otherwise we'll be late.
time / order	first, then, next, after that, finally, meanwhile, while, as soon as, eventually	First mix the flour. Then add eggs.
example	for example, for instance, such as, like, in particular	Many fruits, such as apples, are healthy.
summary	in conclusion, to sum up, overall, in short, all in all	In conclusion, exercise is important.
opinion	in my opinion, I believe, personally, it seems to me	In my opinion, school should start later.

Grammar of the contrast words

Word	Followed by	Example
although / though / even though	subject + verb	Although he was ill, he went to work.
despite / in spite of	noun or -ing	Despite the rain / Despite being ill, he went.
however, nevertheless	starts a new sentence; comma after	He was ill. However, he went to work.
but, yet	joins two clauses (no comma needed unless long)	He was ill but he went to work.
while, whereas	compares two things	He loves tea, whereas she prefers coffee.

BECAUSE / BECAUSE OF · SO / SUCH

because + clause (*because it rained*) · because of + noun (*because of the rain*).
so + adjective/adverb (*so cold*) · such + (a/an) + adjective + noun (*such a cold day*). *so many / so much*.

COMMON MISTAKES

- **✗ Although it was cold, but we went out. → ✓ Although it was cold, we went out. (not both)**
- **✗ Despite of the rain … → ✓ Despite the rain … / ✓ In spite of the rain …**
- **✗ I was late, however I wasn't sorry. (comma splice) → ✓ I was late; however, I wasn't sorry. / ✓ I was late. However, I wasn't sorry.**
- **✗ Because I was tired. I went to bed. → ✓ Because I was tired, I went to bed.**
- **✗ It was so a good film. → ✓ It was such a good film.**

22 Relative clauses

A relative clause gives more information about a noun. It starts with a relative pronoun.

Pronoun	Refers to	Example
who	people (subject / object)	The woman who lives next door is a doctor.
which	things, animals	The book which I read was great.
that	people or things (defining clauses only)	The man that called is my uncle.
whose	possession	The girl whose bag was stolen cried.
where	places	This is the school where I studied.
when	times	I remember the day when we met.
why	reasons	That is the reason why I left.
whom	formal object of people	The person whom I met was kind.

Defining and non-defining

DEFINING (NECESSARY)

Tells which one. No commas. *that* possible.
Pronoun can be left out if it is the object.
The film (that) we saw was long.

NON-DEFINING (EXTRA INFO)

Extra information. Commas around it. No *that*.
Pronoun cannot be left out.
My brother, who lives in Umeå, is a nurse.

- **Whole-sentence which: *He passed the test, which surprised everyone.***
- **Preposition: *The house in which I live* (formal) = *The house (that) I live in.* (normal)**
- **Reduced clauses: *the girl sitting there* (= who is sitting), *the book written by him* (= which was written)**
- **Do not repeat the subject/object: ✗ The man who he called …**

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ The man which called … → ✓ The man who / that called …

> ✗ The book that I read it was good. → ✓ The book that I read was good.

> ✗ My mother, that is a teacher, … → ✓ My mother, who is a teacher, …

> ✗ The girl which bag was stolen … → ✓ The girl whose bag was stolen …

> ✗ What I like is the thing that is cheap what … → ✓ All that I need is … (*what* = "the thing that"; do not combine)

23 Question tags and short answers

23.1 Question tags

A question tag turns a statement into a question asking for agreement. Positive statement → negative tag. Negative statement → positive tag. Use the same auxiliary as in the statement (or *do/does/did* if there is none).

Statement	Tag
You are tired,	aren't you?
She likes tea,	doesn't she?
They didn't come,	did they?
He can swim,	can't he?
You've finished,	haven't you?
I am late,	aren't I? (special)
Let's go,	shall we? (special)
Open the door,	will you? (imperative)
Nobody called,	did they? (nobody/nothing = negative)

Falling intonation = you are sure; rising intonation = you are really asking.

23.2 Short answers and echo questions

Answer yes/no questions with the auxiliary: *Do you like tea? – Yes, I do. / No, I don't.* · *Have you finished? – Yes, I have.* · *Can you swim? – No, I can't.* · *Are you ready? – Yes, I am.*

- So / neither: agreeing. *I like pizza. – So do I.* · *I don't like fish. – Neither do I. / Nor do I.* The auxiliary matches the tense: *I've seen it. – So have I.*
- Echo questions: *I'm tired. – Are you?* shows interest.

23.3 Question forms: a quick review

Type	Pattern	Example
yes/no	auxiliary + subject + verb	Do you smoke? Is she here?
wh- (object)	wh-word + auxiliary + subject + verb	Where do you live? What did she buy?
wh- (subject)	wh-word + verb (no do!)	Who called you? What happened?
preposition	preposition at the end (informal)	Who are you talking to?
indirect	statement order	Do you know where she lives?

COMMON MISTAKES

> ✗ You like tea, isn't it? → ✓ You like tea, don't you? (not the Arabic/Indian-English "isn't it?")

> ✗ Who did call you? → ✓ Who called you?

> ✗ What you want? → ✓ What do you want?

> ✗ She doesn't like it, doesn't she? → ✓ She doesn't like it, does she?

Part 5

Writing

24 Punctuation

Mark	Rules	Example
. full stop	ends a statement; abbreviations are often written without it in British English (Mr, Dr)	I like English.
? question mark	direct questions only (not indirect)	Where is she? · I asked where she was.
! exclamation	strong feeling; rare in essays	What a day!
, comma	list of three or more; after an introductory word/phrase; before *and/but/so* joining two full clauses; around extra info; before direct speech; after "However" etc.	apples, pears, and plums · Yesterday, I went home. · I was tired, but I worked. · My dad, who is a driver, …
; semicolon	joins two closely related full sentences; or separates complex list items	I was tired; I went to bed.
: colon	introduces a list, explanation or quote (after a full clause)	You need three things: time, effort and patience.
' apostrophe	contractions (don't, it's) and possession (Anna's)	It's Anna's bag.
" " quotation	direct speech and quotes; British: single ' ', American: double " "; commas and full stops inside (US) or after (UK)	"I'm ready," she said.
– dash / - hyphen	dash = pause/extra; hyphen = compound words	well-known author · a ten-year-old
( ) brackets	extra information	Stockholm (the capital) is big.

THE 5 COMMA RULES THAT COVER 90 %

1) Lists: A, B and C (Oxford comma before "and" is optional but be consistent).
2) Introductory element: *After school, I went home.*
3) Two full clauses + and/but/so/or: comma before the conjunction. *I wanted to go, but it rained.*
4) Extra information (non-defining): commas on both sides.
5) Direct address / yes / no / however: *Yes, I agree. John, come here.*

NO COMMA BEFORE "THAT" AND NO COMMA BETWEEN SUBJECT AND VERB

✗ I think, that he is right. → ✓ I think that he is right. ✗ The boy, ran home. → ✓ The boy ran home.

Apostrophe in detail

Use	Example
contraction (missing letters)	it's = it is · don't = do not · I'm · you're = you are · there's · who's = who is
possession: singular + 's	the dog's tail, Anna's phone
possession: plural -s + '	the students' books
NOT for plurals	✗ pizza's, 1990's, photo's → ✓ pizzas, 1990s, photos

NOT in possessive pronouns	✗ her's, your's, it's (own) → ✓ hers, yours, its

Capital letters

Capitals for: first word of a sentence, I, names of people and places, nationalities and languages (*Swedish, English, Arabic*), days and months (*Monday, May*), titles before names (*Dr Smith*), main words in titles. No capitals for seasons, school subjects (except languages), compass directions in general (*north*), and a job title not with a name (*the prime minister*).

Sentence boundaries

RUN-ON SENTENCE AND COMMA SPLICE

> ✗ I like English it is fun. (run-on) ✗ I like English, it is fun. (comma splice)
>
> ✓ I like English. It is fun. · ✓ I like English because it is fun. · ✓ I like English; it is fun.
>
> ✗ Because I was tired. (fragment) → ✓ I stayed home because I was tired.

25 Spelling rules

Rule	Examples
i before e, except after c	believe, field, friend · receive, ceiling, deceive (exceptions: weird, seize, science, neighbour, weigh)
drop the silent -e before -ing / -ed / a vowel suffix	make → making, hope → hoped, use → using (keep it before -ly or -ment: safely, achievement)
double the final consonant	(short word, one vowel + one consonant, stressed): stop → stopped, run → running, begin → beginning, prefer → preferred (but visit → visited)
consonant + y → ied / ies	study → studied, try → tries (play → played: vowel + y stays)
-ie → -ying	die → dying, lie → lying
-ful has one l	careful, useful, beautiful, wonderful (but: full)
all + other → one l	already, altogether, always, almost (not allready)
-ly keeps the l	real → really, final → finally, careful → carefully
-able / -ible	readable, comfortable, possible, terrible, responsible
-ance / -ence	importance, difference, independence, performance, experience
-ise / -ize	UK: realise/organise; US: realize/organize (choose one variety and stay with it)

British vs American spelling

UK	US
colour, favourite, neighbour, behaviour	color, favorite, neighbor, behavior
centre, theatre, metre	center, theater, meter
organise, realise, apologise	organize, realize, apologize
travelling, cancelled	traveling, canceled
defence, licence (noun), practise (verb)	defense, license, practice

programme, grey, tyre	program, gray, tire

Words that are often misspelled

a lot (two words)
accommodation
address
argument
beginning
believe
business
calendar
definitely
development
environment
embarrass
February
foreign
government
happened
immediately
independent
knowledge
necessary
occasion
occurred
opportunity
particularly
privilege
professional
recommend
restaurant
separate
successful
surprise
tomorrow
until (one l)
Wednesday
writing
written

TRICK

Make a personal list of your own spelling errors. Write the correct word three times and check it again after a week. A list of only 20 own words fixes most of your mistakes.

26 Confusing words and Swedish false friends

26.1 Words that sound alike or look alike

Words	Difference
their / there / they're	their = belonging to them · there = place · they're = they are
your / you're	your = belonging to you · you're = you are
its / it's	its = belonging to it · it's = it is / it has
to / too / two	to = preposition/infinitive · too = also / more than needed · two = 2
then / than	then = at that time, next · than = comparison
affect / effect	affect (verb) = influence · effect (noun) = result
accept / except	accept = take · except = but not
advice / advise	advice (noun) · advise (verb)
lose / loose	lose = not win, misplace · loose = not tight
quite / quiet / quit	quite = rather · quiet = silent · quit = stop
principal / principle	principal = head of school; main · principle = rule, belief
whose / who's	whose = of whom · who's = who is
weather / whether	weather = rain/sun · whether = if
where / were / wear	where = place · were = past of be · wear = clothes
practice / practise	UK: practice (noun), practise (verb) · US: practice both
break / brake	break = smash/rest · brake = stop a car
hear / here	hear = listen · here = in this place
through / though / thought / tough	through = via · though = although · thought = idea/V2 of think · tough = hard

a lot / alot / allot	a lot (two words) = many
maybe / may be	maybe = perhaps (adverb) · may be = might be (verb)
everyday / every day	everyday (adjective) = ordinary · every day (adverb phrase) = each day

26.2 Swedish false friends

Words that look like Swedish words but mean something different.

Swedish word	Looks like	Real English meaning
eventuellt	eventually	*possibly, perhaps* (eventually = in the end, finally)
aktuell	actual	*current, relevant* (actual = real, true)
sympatisk	sympathetic	*nice, pleasant* (sympathetic = understanding)
gift	gift	*married* (gift = present; Swedish gift = *poison*)
fabrik	fabric	*factory* (fabric = tyg)
sensibel	sensible	*sensitive* (sensible = förnuftig)
handla	handle	*shop* (handle = hantera, klara av)
chef	chef	*boss, manager* (chef = kock)
bekomma	become	*agree with (food); affect* (become = bli)
genial	genial	*brilliant* (genial = vänlig)
kurs	course	*course* and *exchange rate*; but *curse* = förbannelse
kontrollera	control	*check* (control = styra, ha makt över)

Also remember: *I have 17 years* is wrong (*I am 17*). Swedish "i" can be *in, at* or *on*: *i skolan = at school*, *i Stockholm = in Stockholm*.

27 Typical mistakes for Swedish and Arabic speakers

These are errors that are very common in school writing. Learn to spot them. Each one has an example that shows the rule.

Area	✗ Common mistake	✓ Correct	Why
Word order	✗ Yesterday went I to school.	✓ Yesterday I went to school.	English keeps S + V even after a time word (no V2 rule like Swedish).
Word order	✗ I like very much football.	✓ I like football very much.	verb + object stay together; adverbs go after.
Verb "to be"	✗ She very nice. / I have 17 years.	✓ She is very nice. / I am 17.	English needs "be". Age uses "be".
Verb -s	✗ He play football.	✓ He plays football.	he/she/it + -s in present simple.
Do-support	✗ I no like tea. / Like you tea?	✓ I don't like tea. / Do you like tea?	do/does/did needed in negatives and questions.
Present perfect	✗ I live here since 2020.	✓ I have lived here since 2020.	since/for + situation that continues → present perfect.
Past tense	✗ I have seen him yesterday.	✓ I saw him yesterday.	finished time → past simple.

Progressive	✗ I am wanting a coffee.	✓ I want a coffee.	stative verbs (want, know, like) have no -ing.
Articles	✗ I am student.	✓ I am a student.	singular countable noun needs a/the.
Plural	✗ two child / many informations	✓ two children / a lot of information	irregular and uncountable nouns.
Adjective	✗ the cars are expensives	✓ the cars are expensive	no plural -s on adjectives (Arabic agreement is wrong in English).
Pronoun	✗ My mother she is a nurse.	✓ My mother is a nurse.	do not repeat the subject.
Preposition	✗ I am good in math. / depend of	✓ good at math / depend on	fixed combinations.
There is	✗ Have many people here.	✓ There are many people here.	use "there is / are" for existence.
Gerund	✗ I like to swimming.	✓ I like swimming / to swim.	to + base or -ing, not both.
Time clause	✗ When I will come, …	✓ When I come, …	present tense in time and if clauses.
Indirect question	✗ I don't know where is he.	✓ I don't know where he is.	statement order after question word.
Double negative	✗ I don't have no money.	✓ I don't have any money.	one negative per clause.
Prepositions of time	✗ in Monday	✓ on Monday	days = on.
Superlative	✗ the most easiest	✓ the easiest	one marker only.
Say / tell	✗ He said me a story.	✓ He told me a story.	tell + person; say + words.
Capital letters	✗ on monday, i think swedish	✓ on Monday, I think Swedish	days, languages, I.

28 Writing a good text

28.1 Structure of an essay

INTRODUCTION

- Hook (question, fact, short story)
- Background
- Thesis: your main idea in one sentence

BODY (2–3 PARAGRAPHS)

- One idea per paragraph
- Topic sentence
- Explanation, example, link back to the thesis

CONCLUSION

- Restate the thesis in new words
- Sum up your main points
- Final thought (no new arguments)

28.2 PEEL for a paragraph

P	Point	The main idea of the paragraph
E	Evidence	fact, quote or example
E	Explain	why this supports your point
L	Link	connect back to the question / thesis

28.3 Style

- Vary sentence length. Mix short sentences with longer ones that use linkers.
- Be specific. *A lot of people → about 60 % of teenagers*. Prefer exact verbs: *say → claim, explain, argue*.
- Avoid "thing", "stuff", "good", "bad", "very". Use *beneficial, harmful, extremely useful*.
- Formal writing: no contractions (*do not*), no slang, no "you" for general statements (*people / one*), no exclamation marks.
- Informal writing (blog, email to friend): contractions and short phrases are fine.
- Be concise. Delete words that add nothing: *in my personal opinion → in my opinion*.
- Active voice is usually stronger than passive.

28.4 Useful phrases

Starting	Arguing	Ending
It is often said that …	One reason is that …	In conclusion, …
Nowadays, …	For example, …	To sum up, …
Many people believe that …	This shows that …	Taking everything into account, …
This essay will discuss …	Some people disagree because …	For these reasons, …

28.5 Formal letters and emails

- Dear Mr Smith, (name known) · Dear Sir or Madam, (name unknown)
- Opening: *I am writing to enquire about / to apply for / to complain about …*
- Closing: *Yours sincerely* (name known) · *Yours faithfully* (name unknown) · *Kind regards* (email)

29 Proofreading: how to find your own mistakes

THE 6-PASS METHOD

Read your text 6 times, each time looking for one kind of mistake. This works much better than reading once and looking for everything.

Pass	Look for	Check
1 Verbs	subject-verb agreement, tense, irregular forms	Does every verb have a subject? he/she/it + -s? Same time frame? V2 vs V3?
2 Sentences	fragments, run-ons, comma splices, word order	Does every sentence have subject + verb? Is it a complete idea?
3 Nouns	articles, plurals, uncountables	a / the / nothing? information (not informations)?
4 Small words	prepositions, pronouns, linkers	depend on, good at, *although … but*?
5 Punctuation	commas, apostrophes, capitals	its/it's? their/there? capital for I, days, languages?
6 Spelling	commonly misspelled and confusing words	Read backwards, word by word. Use a dictionary for doubtful words.

PROOFREADING TRICKS

- Wait (at least some hours) before you proofread.
- Read aloud slowly; your ear catches missing words.
- Change the look: print it or change the font.
- Know your own top 5 mistakes and search for those specifically.
- Read from the last sentence to the first to focus on the sentence, not the story.

Correction symbols (used by many teachers)

Symbol	Meaning	Example
Sp	spelling	enviroment → environment
T	wrong tense	I have seen it yesterday → saw
V / SV	wrong verb form / agreement	He go → He goes
WO	word order	Always I → I always
Prep	wrong preposition	good in → good at
Art	article missing / wrong	I am student → a student
P	punctuation	its → it's
^	word missing	I ^ going → I am going
?	unclear	rewrite the sentence
//	new paragraph	

MY PERSONAL CHECKLIST (COPY IT IN YOUR NOTEBOOK)

- ☐ Does each sentence have a subject and a verb?
- ☐ Are all verbs in the right tense and the right form (-s, V2, V3)?
- ☐ Did I use a / the / nothing correctly?
- ☐ Are the plurals and uncountables right?
- ☐ Are all prepositions fixed combinations I know?
- ☐ Did I use because / although / however with the correct grammar?
- ☐ Are commas and apostrophes correct (its/it's, your/you're)?
- ☐ Did I use capital letters for I, days, languages, names?
- ☐ Did I check my own top 5 mistakes?

Part 6

Practice, answer key, quick reference, sources

★ Exercises 1–29

Write your answers in pencil. Check with the answer key only after you finish a whole exercise. Write your answers on the lines. Copy every mistake into your mistake list (right after the exercises).

Exercise 1: Word classes

Name the word class of the underlined idea (noun, verb, adjective, adverb, preposition, conjunction, pronoun) for the bold word.

1. **She quickly closed the door.**

2. **The tall man waved.**

3. **Put the book on the table.**

4. **They live in Malmö.**

5. **I was tired, but I worked.**

6. **Her honesty surprised me.**

7. **We decided to leave.**

8. **He is very kind.**

Exercise 2: Sentences and word order

Put the words in the correct order.

1. always / I / breakfast / eat / at 7
2. went / yesterday / we / to the cinema
3. she / football / well / plays
4. know / do / where / you / he lives
5. is / there / a / on the table / book
6. never / late / is / he
7. you / what / want / do
8. to school / on foot / goes / Ali / every day

Exercise 3: To be, to have, to do

Fill in the correct form of *be, have, do* or *make*.

1. She _____ two brothers. (have)
2. _____ you like pizza? (do)
3. They _____ at home yesterday. (be)
4. I _____ a mistake. (make/do)
5. He _____ not like fish. (do)
6. We _____ our homework every day. (make/do)
7. _____ there any milk? (be)
8. My parents _____ in Sweden since 2015. (be, perfect)

Exercise 4: Tenses overview

Name the tense of the sentence.

1. She has finished.

2. They were playing.

3. I will have left.

4. He had been waiting.

5. We work here.

6. It is raining.

7. She will be sleeping.

8. I visited Rome.

Exercise 5: Present simple / continuous

Choose the correct form of the verb in brackets.

1. She usually _____ coffee. (drink)

2. Look! It _____ . (snow)

3. I _____ what you mean. (understand)

4. Water _____ at 100 °C. (boil)

5. He _____ TV at the moment. (watch)

6. _____ she _____ French? (speak)

7. They _____ to school by bus. (not go)

8. I _____ this phone. I think it's great. (like)

Exercise 6: Past simple / continuous

Choose past simple or past continuous.

1. I _____ when the phone rang. (sleep)
2. She _____ the exam last week. (pass)
3. While we _____ , it began to rain. (walk)
4. He _____ me yesterday. (not call)
5. When I was young, I _____ in the river every summer. (swim; habit)
6. What _____ you _____ at 8 last night? (do)
7. They _____ dinner when the lights went out. (eat)
8. _____ you _____ the film last night? (see)

Exercise 7: Present perfect

Fill in: present perfect or past simple. Use *for* / *since* / *ago* where needed.

1. I _____ here since 2020. (live)
2. She _____ to Spain in 2019. (go)
3. We have known each other _____ ten years. (for/since)
4. He has worked here _____ January. (for/since)
5. I _____ my keys. I can't find them. (lose)
6. They moved here three years _____ . (ago)
7. _____ you ever _____ sushi? (eat)
8. She has _____ been to Japan. (never/ago)

Exercise 8: Past perfect

Past simple or past perfect?

1. When I arrived, the film _____ . (already / start)

2. She was tired because she _____ all night. (work)

3. After he _____ lunch, he went out. (eat)

4. I _____ never _____ snow before I came here. (see)

5. They _____ for an hour when the bus came. (wait)

6. He said he _____ the book. (finish)

7. By the time we got there, they _____ . (leave)

8. I _____ him yesterday. (see)

Exercise 9: The future

Choose the best future form.

1. The phone's ringing. – I _____ it. (get)

2. Look at the clouds! It _____ rain. (going to)

3. I _____ Sara at 6 tomorrow. (meet; arrangement)

4. The train _____ at 7.45. (leave; timetable)

5. When I _____ home, I will call you. (get)

6. If it _____ tomorrow, we'll stay home. (rain)

7. This time next week I _____ on a beach. (lie)

8. By 2030 I _____ school. (finish)

Exercise 10: Irregular verbs

Write the past simple and past participle.

1. **write**

2. **buy**

3. **swim**

4. **choose**

5. **lie (rest)**

6. **teach**

7. **bite**

8. **fly**

Exercise 11: Modal verbs

Choose the correct modal.

1. **You _____ smoke here. It is forbidden. (mustn't/don't have to)**

2. **You _____ come if you don't want to. (mustn't/don't have to)**

3. **She _____ be at home. The lights are on. (must/can't)**

4. **I _____ have seen him. I wasn't there. (couldn't/needn't)**

5. **You _____ study more. (advice)**

6. **_____ you open the window, please? (polite request)**

7. **I _____ have gone to the party, but I was ill. (would/should)**

8. **He _____ swim when he was five. (can/could)**

Exercise 12: The passive

Change into the passive.

1. They built the bridge in 1998.

2. Someone has stolen my bike.

3. They will announce the results on Friday.

4. The teacher is checking the tests.

5. People speak English here.

6. They gave me a prize.

7. You must finish this today.

8. The cleaner cleaned the room.

Exercise 13: Conditionals

Fill in the correct form.

1. If it _____ tomorrow, we'll stay home. (rain)

2. If I _____ rich, I would travel the world. (be)

3. If I _____ harder, I would have passed. (study)

4. If you heat ice, it _____ . (melt)

5. If I _____ you, I would apologise. (be)

6. I wish I _____ more time. (have)

7. I wish I _____ the answer yesterday. (know)

8. _____ you hurry, you'll miss the bus. (unless/if)

Exercise 14: Reported speech

Change into reported speech.

1. **"I like pizza," she said.**

2. **"I am working," he said.**

3. **"I will call you," she said.**

4. **"Where do you live?" he asked me.**

5. **"Do you like tea?" she asked.**

6. **"Sit down!" the teacher said to us.**

7. **"I have seen it," he said.**

8. **"Don't be late," she told him.**

Exercise 15: Infinitive, -ing, phrasal verbs

Choose the infinitive (to + V) or -ing form.

1. I enjoy _____ . (swim)

2. She decided _____ home. (go)

3. I'm looking forward to _____ you. (see)

4. He made me _____ . (laugh)

5. I stopped _____ because I was tired. (run)

6. Remember _____ the door when you leave. (lock)

7. She is good at _____ . (draw)

8. Please turn _____ the light. (off; phrasal verb)

Exercise 16: Nouns and quantity

Choose the correct word.

1. There isn't much _____ in the fridge. (food/foods)

2. Can you give me some _____ ? (advice/advices)

3. I have a lot of _____ . (homework/homeworks)

4. There are _____ people here today. (fewer/less)

5. The news _____ good. (is/are)

6. The _____ toys are on the floor. (several girls: girl's / girls')

7. Plural of *child*: _____

8. Plural of *city*: _____

Exercise 17: Articles

Write *a, an, the* or – (nothing).

1. She is _____ engineer.

2. _____ Sun is a star.

3. I love _____ music.

4. I go to _____ school every day.

5. He plays _____ guitar.

6. _____ life is short.

7. It was _____ best day of my life.

8. I live in _____ Sweden.

Exercise 18: Pronouns

Choose the correct pronoun.

1. She gave the book to _____ . (I)

2. This is not your pen. It is _____ . (I)

3. The dog hurt _____ . (reflexive)

4. My friend and _____ went home. (I/me)

5. They help _____ . (each other/themselves)

6. Between you and _____ , it is a secret. (I/me)

7. The cat licked _____ paws. (it)

8. These are their books. The books are _____ . (they)

Exercise 19: Adjectives and adverbs

Choose adjective or adverb, or write the comparative/superlative.

1. He runs very _____ . (quick)

2. She speaks English _____ . (good)

3. This book is _____ than that one. (interesting)

4. He is the _____ boy in the class. (tall)

5. The soup tastes _____ . (good)

6. It's getting _____ and _____ . (cold)

7. She is _____ than me. (good)

8. The lesson was _____ . I felt _____ . (bore)

Exercise 20: Prepositions

Fill in the correct preposition.

1. I was born _____ 2008.

2. The meeting is _____ Monday _____ 9 o'clock.

3. I'm good _____ maths.

4. She depends _____ her parents.

5. We have lived here _____ ten years.

6. He arrived _____ the station _____ noon.

7. I'm interested _____ music.

8. They agree _____ me.

Exercise 21: Linking words

Choose the correct linking word.

1. _____ it rained, we went out. (although/despite)
2. _____ the rain, we went out. (although/despite)
3. I stayed home _____ I was ill. (because/because of)
4. He was late _____ the traffic. (because/because of)
5. Study hard, _____ you will fail. (otherwise/however)
6. It was _____ a good film that I watched it twice. (so/such)
7. I study _____ I can get a good job. (so that/in spite of)
8. She likes tea, _____ he prefers coffee. (whereas/because)

Exercise 22: Relative clauses

Fill in who, which, that, whose, where or – (nothing).

1. The woman _____ lives next door is a doctor.
2. The book _____ I read was great.
3. The boy _____ bike was stolen was sad.
4. This is the house _____ I was born.
5. My brother, _____ lives in Umeå, is a nurse.
6. He passed the test, _____ surprised everyone.
7. The man _____ I met was kind.
8. I remember the day _____ we met.

Exercise 23: Question tags

Add a question tag.

1. **You are tired, _____ ?**

2. **She likes tea, _____ ?**

3. **They didn't come, _____ ?**

4. **He can swim, _____ ?**

5. **Let's go, _____ ?**

6. **I'm late, _____ ?**

7. **Open the door, _____ ?**

8. **Nobody called, _____ ?**

Exercise 24: Punctuation

Add the missing punctuation / correct the sentence.

1. **my friend who lives in london is a doctor**

2. **however i disagree**

3. **its a nice day isnt it**

4. **i bought apples pears and plums**

5. **the students books were on the table**

6. **she said im tired**

7. **i was tired i went to bed**

8. **what time does the film start**

Exercise 25: Spelling

Choose the correct spelling.

1. recieve / receive

2. begining / beginning

3. definately / definitely

4. neccessary / necessary

5. studing / studying

6. tomorow / tomorrow

7. occured / occurred

8. beautifull / beautiful

Exercise 26: Confusing words

Choose the correct word.

1. It was _____ cold to go out. (to/too)

2. _____ car is that? (Whose/Who's)

3. I have _____ many things to do. (to/too)

4. The _____ is nice today. (weather/whether)

5. She is taller _____ me. (then/than)

6. This _____ my friend. (is/its)

7. The dog wagged _____ tail. (its/it's)

8. I _____ your offer. (accept/except)

Exercise 27: Typical mistakes

Correct the mistake.

1. I am student.

2. He play football.

3. I have seen him yesterday.

4. Informations are important.

5. We discussed about the plan.

6. Yesterday went I home.

7. I live here since 2020.

8. My mother she is a nurse.

Exercise 28: Writing a good text

Short answers.

1. What three parts does an essay have?

2. What does PEEL stand for?

3. Which is more formal: *don't* or *do not*?

4. Give a stronger word for *good*.

5. What goes in the thesis statement?

6. Which closing is correct for *Dear Sir or Madam*?

7. Should a conclusion contain new arguments?

8. Give two linkers for contrast.

Exercise 29: Proofreading

Answer.

1. **How many passes does the proofreading method have?**

2. **What does the symbol Sp mean?**

3. **What does WO mean?**

4. **Which trick helps you hear missing words?**

5. **Why read from the last sentence to the first?**

6. **What should you write on your personal list?**

7. **What does the caret ^ mean?**

8. **When should you proofread?**

★ My mistake list

Write every mistake here: the rule, the wrong sentence and the correct sentence. Read this list before every writing test.

Rule / chapter	Wrong → Correct	Repeated

My mistake list (continued)

Rule / chapter	Wrong → Correct	Repeated

★ Find the mistakes

Each text contains hidden mistakes. Use the 6-pass method (chapter 29). Underline each mistake and write the correction in the margin. The number of mistakes is given. Check the key at the end.

Text A: My weekend (12 mistakes)

> **Last weekend I have visited my grandmother. She live in a small village near Göteborg. We went their by train, and it taked two hours. When we arrived, my grandmother was cooking dinner. She is very good in cooking, and the food was delicious. After the dinner we looked at old photos. I learned alot about my family history. I also met my cousin which lives nearby. Before I left, she gived me two advices about studying. I enjoyed me very much. In the evening it was raining, so we stayed inside and played cards. I was so tired that I fell asleep immediately. Next weekend I will visit her again, if I will have time.**

Write the corrections here:

Text B: Social media (14 mistakes)

> **Nowadays many teenager spend too much time on social media. According to a recent study, young people use their phones for more than five hours every days. Some people says that this is not a problem, but I disagree with them. There is many reasons for this. First of all, social media can affect your sleep bad. If you stay up late looking at your phone, you will be tired in the morning. The informations in the report are clear. I am agree with the experts, who say that sleeping eight hours is more better than scrolling. Furthermore, it is easy to compare yourself with others, which can make you feeling unhappy. Despite of these problems, social media also has advantages. For example, it help us to keep in touch with friends who lives far away. In my opinion, the key is to use it less and to spend more time with real people. Everyone should decide how much time they want to spend on his phone.**

Write the corrections here:

Text C: A formal email (14 mistakes)

> **Dear Sir or Madam,**
>
> **I am writing to complain about the laptop that I bought from your shop last week. Unfortunately, the screen stopped working after only three days, and the laptop didn't worked properly from the beginning. I have contacted your customer service yesterday, but nobody answered to me. I am very disappointed, specially because it was a expensive model. Me and my family depend of this computer for school and work. I would like to know if you can to repair it or give me my money back. I have attached a copy of the receipt, which prove that I bought it on 3 October. Please send me a answer and more informations about your return policy. If I will not hear from you within a week, I will contact the consumer agency. I look forward to hear from you soon.**
>
> **Yours sincerely,**
>
> **Karl Nilsson**

Write the corrections here:

★ Answer key

1. Word classes

1 adverb
2 adjective
3 preposition
4 pronoun
5 conjunction
6 noun
7 verb
8 adverb

2. Sentences and word order

1 I always eat breakfast at 7.
2 We went to the cinema yesterday.
3 She plays football well.
4 Do you know where he lives?
5 There is a book on the table.
6 He is never late.
7 What do you want?
8 Ali goes to school on foot every day.

3. To be, to have, to do

1 has
2 Do
3 were
4 made
5 does
6 do
7 Is
8 have been

4. Tenses overview

1 present perfect
2 past continuous
3 future perfect
4 past perfect continuous
5 present simple
6 present continuous
7 future continuous
8 past simple

5. Present simple / continuous

1 drinks
2 is snowing
3 understand
4 boils
5 is watching
6 Does … speak
7 don't go
8 like

6. Past simple / continuous

1 was sleeping
2 passed
3 were walking
4 didn't call
5 used to swim / swam
6 were … doing
7 were eating
8 Did … see

7. Present perfect

1 have lived
2 went
3 for
4 since
5 have lost
6 ago
7 Have … eaten
8 never

8. Past perfect

1 had already started
2 had worked
3 had eaten
4 had … seen
5 had been waiting
6 had finished
7 had left
8 saw

9. The future

1 'll get
2 is going to
3 am meeting
4 leaves
5 get
6 rains
7 will be lying
8 will have finished

10. Irregular verbs

1 wrote – written
2 bought – bought
3 swam – swum
4 chose – chosen
5 lay – lain
6 taught – taught
7 bit – bitten
8 flew – flown

11. Modal verbs

1 mustn't
2 don't have to
3 must
4 couldn't
5 should
6 Could
7 would
8 could

12. The passive

1 The bridge was built in 1998.
2 My bike has been stolen.
3 The results will be announced on Friday.
4 The tests are being checked.
5 English is spoken here.
6 I was given a prize. / A prize was given to me.
7 This must be finished today.
8 The room was cleaned.

13. Conditionals

1 rains
2 were
3 had studied
4 melts
5 were
6 had
7 had known
8 Unless

14. Reported speech

1 She said (that) she liked pizza.
2 He said (that) he was working.
3 She said (that) she would call me.
4 He asked me where I lived.
5 She asked if/whether I liked tea.
6 The teacher told us to sit down.
7 He said (that) he had seen it.
8 She told him not to be late.

15. Infinitive, -ing, phrasal verbs

1 swimming
2 to go
3 seeing
4 laugh
5 running
6 to lock
7 drawing
8 off

16. Nouns and quantity

1 food
2 advice
3 homework
4 fewer
5 is
6 girls'
7 children
8 cities

17. Articles

1 an
2 The
3 –
4 –
5 the
6 –
7 the
8 –

18. Pronouns

1 me
2 mine
3 itself
4 I
5 each other
6 me
7 its
8 theirs

19. Adjectives and adverbs

1 quickly
2 well
3 more interesting
4 tallest
5 good
6 colder … colder
7 better
8 boring … bored

20. Prepositions

1 in
2 on … at
3 at
4 on
5 for
6 at … at
7 in
8 with

21. Linking words

1 Although
2 Despite
3 because
4 because of
5 otherwise
6 such
7 so that
8 whereas

22. Relative clauses

1 who/that
2 which/that/–
3 whose
4 where
5 who
6 which
7 whom/who/that/–
8 when

23. Question tags

1 aren't you
2 doesn't she
3 did they
4 can't he
5 shall we
6 aren't I
7 will you
8 did they

24. Punctuation

1 My friend, who lives in London, is a doctor.
2 However, I disagree.
3 It's a nice day, isn't it?
4 I bought apples, pears and plums.
5 The students' books were on the table.
6 She said, "I'm tired."
7 I was tired, so I went to bed. / I was tired; I went to bed.
8 What time does the film start?

25. Spelling

1 receive
2 beginning
3 definitely
4 necessary
5 studying
6 tomorrow
7 occurred
8 beautiful

26. Confusing words

1 too
2 Whose
3 too
4 weather
5 than
6 is
7 its
8 accept

27. Typical mistakes

1 I am a student.
2 He plays football.
3 I saw him yesterday.
4 Information is important.
5 We discussed the plan.
6 Yesterday I went home.
7 I have lived here since 2020.
8 My mother is a nurse.

28. Writing a good text

1 introduction, body, conclusion
2 Point, Evidence, Explain, Link
3 do not
4 e.g. excellent, beneficial, valuable
5 your main idea or argument
6 Yours faithfully
7 No
8 however, although (also nevertheless, whereas)

29. Proofreading

1 6 (verbs, sentences, nouns, small words, punctuation, spelling)
2 spelling
3 word order
4 read aloud
5 you focus on each sentence, not the story
6 your own top 5 mistakes
7 a word is missing
8 after waiting a while (hours)

Find the mistakes: key

Text A (12): 1 have visited → visited · 2 live → lives · 3 their → there · 4 taked → took · 5 good in → good at · 6 After the dinner → After dinner · 7 alot → a lot · 8 cousin which → cousin who · 9 gived → gave · 10 two advices → two pieces of advice / some advice · 11 enjoyed me → enjoyed myself · 12 if I will have → if I have.

Text B (14): 1 many teenager → teenagers · 2 every days → every day · 3 people says → say · 4 There is many → There are many · 5 sleep bad → badly · 6 The informations → The information · 7 …are clear → is clear · 8 I am agree → I agree · 9

more better → better · 10 make you feeling → feel · 11 Despite of → Despite · 12 it help → helps · 13 friends who lives → live · 14 on his phone → on their phone.

Text C (14): 1 didn't worked → didn't work · 2 have contacted … yesterday → contacted · 3 answered to me → answered me · 4 specially → especially · 5 a expensive → an expensive · 6 Me and my family → My family and I · 7 depend of → depend on · 8 can to repair → can repair · 9 which prove → which proves · 10 a answer → an answer · 11 informations → information · 12 If I will not hear → If I do not hear · 13 look forward to hear → to hearing · 14 Yours sincerely → Yours faithfully (after "Dear Sir or Madam").

★ Quick reference: one page to keep

TENSE FORMULAS

Present simple: V1 (+s)
Present cont.: am/is/are + V-ing
Past simple: V2 · Past cont.: was/were + V-ing
Present perfect: have/has + V3
Past perfect: had + V3
Future: will + V1 · am/is/are going to + V1
Passive: be + V3
Modal: modal + V1 · modal + have + V3

CONDITIONALS

0: if + present, present
1: if + present, will + V1
2: if + past, would + V1
3: if + had + V3, would have + V3
wish + past (now) · wish + had + V3 (past)

TIME WORDS

for + period · since + starting point
ago + past simple · already/yet/just + perfect
when/while/before/after/if/unless + present for the future

PREPOSITIONS OF TIME AND PLACE

at 5, at night · on Monday, on 5 May · in May, in 2024, in the morning
in a city · on a street · at a number/point

ARTICLES

a/an = one, first mention · the = specific, known · nothing = plural/uncountable in general, names, languages, sports, meals

CONTRAST

although + clause · despite + noun/-ing · however, + new sentence · whereas = compare

THE 10 MOST COMMON MISTAKES

1 he/she/it + -s · 2 a/the missing · 3 informations/advices · 4 tense (perfect vs past) · 5 depend of / good in · 6 word order in questions · 7 will after when/if · 8 its/it's, their/there · 9 comma splice · 10 capital letters (I, Monday, English)

IRREGULAR CHECK LIST (TOP 20)

be/was/been · do/did/done · go/went/gone · have/had/had · see/saw/seen · take/took/taken · give/gave/given · write/wrote/written · speak/spoke/spoken · buy/bought · think/thought · teach/taught · begin/began/begun · drink/drank/drunk · choose/chose/chosen · know/knew/known · come/came/come · run/ran/run · lie/lay/lain · lay/laid/laid

★ Sources and how to use them

Honest note: this booklet was written from the author's knowledge of English grammar, and is organised after common grammar syllabi. It was not copied from any single book. Grammar rules are stable, but you should check anything that feels unclear against the reliable sources below. If a source disagrees with this booklet, trust the source and correct your copy.

Source	What it is good for
Michael Swan, *Practical English Usage* (Oxford University Press)	The standard reference for "why is it said this way?". Look up any word or rule in the index.
Raymond Murphy, *English Grammar in Use* (Cambridge University Press)	Clear explanations with many exercises, ordered by topic.
Cambridge Dictionary: Grammar (dictionary.cambridge.org/grammar)	Free, searchable grammar explanations with examples (British English).

British Council, LearnEnglish Grammar (learnenglish.britishcouncil.org)	**Free grammar lessons and exercises with answers, level-marked A1–C2.**
Purdue OWL (owl.purdue.edu)	**Free writing and punctuation guide, essays, proofreading.**
Oxford Learner's Dictionaries (oxfordlearnersdictionaries.com)	**Definitions, pronunciation, grammar patterns for each word, irregular verbs.**
Collins COBUILD / Longman Dictionary of Contemporary English (ldoceonline.com)	**Authentic example sentences; usage notes; common collocations.**
Your school's English teacher and textbook	**Always the final authority for your grade: ask them if you are not sure.**

NEXT STEPS AFTER THIS BOOKLET

1) Redo the exercises you got wrong after 2 days and after 7 days. 2) Write one short text a week and proofread it with the 6 passes. 3) Keep a mistake list and read it before every writing test. 4) Read English every day (news, books, subtitles) and notice the grammar you have learned here.